Mental Health AWARENESS WEEK

12-18th May

MENTAL HEALTH FOUNDATION

WHAT IS MENTAL HEALTH AWARENESS WEEK?

Mental Health Awareness Week happens every year, and it's the biggest opportunity for the whole of the UK to come together and focus on getting good mental health. It aims to tackle stigma and help people understand and prioritise mental health.

The Mental Health Foundation started Mental Health Awareness Week in 2001. They set the theme and dates, as well as coordinate different activities for the week. In recent years, it has evolved to focus on preventing mental health problems and has become one of the most high-profile public campaigns in the UK.

Each May, millions of people across the UK take part. Schools, charities, families, celebrities and many others continue to actively support the week.

Since 2001, the Mental Health Foundation has been leading Mental Health Awareness Week - bringing the UK together to focus on getting good mental health. This year, the week takes place from 12 to 18 May 2025 and the theme is 'community'.



THE MENTAL HEALTH FOUNDATION

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The Mental Health Foundation leads Mental Health Awareness Week every year. Here are some useful pages on their website you could check out!

HOW TO MANAGE FEAR AND ANXIETY

HOW TO MANAGE AND REDUCE STRESS

THIS YEARS THEME OF COMMUNITY

The aim of this month's theme is to celebrate the power and importance of community.
Being part of a safe, positive community is vital for our mental health and wellbeing. We thrive when we have strong connections with other people and supportive communities that remind us, we are not alone.
Communities can provide a sense of belonging, safety, support in hard times, and give us a sense purpose.

We know that being part of a community is vital for our mental health and wellbeing. We thrive when we have strong connections with others and supportive communities around us.
We also know that people who are more socially connected to family, friends, or their community are happier, physically healthier, and live longer, with fewer mental health problems than people who are less well connected.
Communities can provide us with a sense of belonging, safety, support in hard times, and give us purpose.
So, this Mental Health Awareness Week we want to celebrate the communities that support us to protect and nurture good mental health.

Your communities could be people who live close to you or people online. A community is a group of people brought together through something which you share in common.

WHAT DO YOU DO WITH YOUR FRIENDS/FAMILY?

Your friends and family are great to develop your community: improving your belonging, reducing loneliness and improving your mental health!

This could be: walks in the park, play video games, playing in your local football team... So what do you do?



10 WAYS TO GET INVOLVED WITH YOUR COMMUNITY

From book club to art class, Swifties to gamers, volunteer groups to shooting hoops – community is good for our mental health. They help us to belong, feel supported, and have purpose. Here are ten ways to get involved with your community and boost your mental health:

1 MAKE IT FUN!
You could choose an activity that you are interested in. This could be a cooking club. Or football. Joining a club that you find fun can help.

2 GET OUTSIDE
Being out and about and moving around in nature has been found to support mental health. You could go on walks with friends.

3 FIND LIKE MINDED PEOPLE
Build connections with people who share your interests and values. But don't forget it is good to meet people who are different from you, too!

4 SHOW KINDNESS TO OTHERS
You can connect with your community by doing small acts of kindness. This benefits others but also yourself.

5 SHOW YOUR APPRECIATION
Sharing a compliment or showing appreciation can strengthen your relationships.

6 CONNECT ONLINE
Find others who share similar experiences or interests online. Remember, healthy online communities should make you feel safe and valued! If an online community makes you uncomfortable, tell a trusted adult.

7 GIVE BACK
Helping others is a great way to build community and give you a feeling of purpose.

8 CARE FOR YOUR LOCAL COMMUNITY
Increase your sense of belonging by getting involved in your local community. You could volunteer with a local gardening club. Or volunteer at a care home.

9 WELCOME OTHERS
Make new people joining your community feel welcome and included. If a new student joins your school, talk to them!

10 FIND PEER SUPPORT IF YOU ARE STRUGGLING
Connect with others going through similar experiences through peer support groups.



YOU ARE NOT ALONE!

Struggling with your mental health can feel quite isolating. It can sometimes make you feel that you are the only one struggling with this.

YOU ARE NOT ALONE!

Almost one third (32.8%) of 17-24 year olds have self-harmed or attempted to self-harm at some point.

One in five young people aged 8-25 had a probable mental health condition in 2023.

WHAT ARE THE BENEFITS OF COMMUNITY?

- Increases connection
- Promotes a sense of belonging
- Reduces isolation
- Reduces loneliness



ONLINE MENTAL HEALTH SUPPORT SERVICES

SUSSEX MENTAL HEALTHLINE

You can call the **Sussex Mental Health Crisis Line** 24/7 by calling the **NHS 111** and selecting the mental health line at **2.**

Or you can use the **NHS free crisis support text messaging service** by texting the word **SUSSEX** to **85258** for a confidential conversation with trained volunteers.

SHOUT

Shout is a service for anyone struggling to cope and needs someone to listen.

You can text **SHOUT** to **85258** for free, confidential support, **24/7.**

shout 85258 here for you 24/7

THE SAMARITANS

The Samaritans offer free emotional support **24/7.**

You can call the Samaritans helpline at **116 123**

CALM HELPLINE AND WEBCHAT

Call the **CALM Helpline** on **0800 58 58 58** or use their **webchat.**

THE MIND INFO-LINE

Call **0300 123 3393** to seek answers about mental health problems, where to get help and alternative treatments.

THE MIND SUPPORT-LINE

Call **0300 102 1234** to get a safe space to talk about your feelings. All of their responders are trained to listen.

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